

Advanced algebraic expressions + two-step equations

Unit 3 · Algebra (T3 · T7) · 65 minutes · 1-to-3 Online Lesson

Corresponding textbooks: "New Thinking in Primary School Mathematics (Second Edition)" Volume 5C
Unit 9 + Modern Education 5C Unit 21-22

Core traps: ● High frequency

The sub-test must be taken every year, accounting for about 12-15% of Paper 1 **Prerequisite knowledge:** Class 14 (Algebraic expression recognition + simple equations) · Class 15 (Equation problems) · Class 27 (Decimal division)

Objective of this class: ❶ Simplification of algebraic expressions (including brackets + distributive law) ❷ $ax+b=c$ type two-step equation ❸ $a(x+b)=c$ type equation ❹ Equation word problems

Our goals: ❶ Simplification of algebraic expressions (including brackets + distributive law) ❷ $ax+b=c$ -type two-step equation ❸ $a(x+b)=c$ -type equation ❹ Equation word problems

Student Name:

Class:

Date:

Time Spent:

I. Warm-Up Questions (total 5 question · 5 minutes)

#	Question	Difficulty	Working Space (write out complete process)
1	Simplify: $3a + 5a = ?$	Basic	
2	Simplify: $7b - 2b = ?$	Basic	
3	Find the value of $2x + 5$ when $x = 3$.	Basic	
4	Solve the equation: $x + 7 = 15$ (one-step equation review)	Basic	
5	Solve the equation: $3y = 18$ (one-step equation review)	Basic	

II. Core Knowledge + Worked Examples

Knowledge point 1: Advanced algebraic expressions - including parenthetical simplification and distributive law ● SSPA

- ① **Merge similar items (review):** Only items with the same letters and the same exponent can be merged.
For example, $3a + 2a = 5a$, but $3a + 2b$ cannot be combined
- ② **Distributive law (new learning):** $a(b + c) = ab + ac$; $a(b - c) = ab - ac$
- ③ **Rules for removing brackets:** The word "+" before the bracket → remove the bracket directly; the word before the bracket is "-" → change the sign of each item after removing the bracket
- ④ **Simplification steps:** ① Remove the brackets (use the distributive law) → ② Combine similar terms → ③ Write the simplest form
- ⑤ **Common traps:** $3(x + 2)$ Many people only multiply the first term and write it as $3x + 2$ (forget that $3 \times 2 = 6$!)

❏ Example of trap detonation (the most important demonstration in this class)

Simplify: $3(x + 2) + 2(x - 1)$

✗ **Common mistakes (65% students)**

$$3x + 2 + 2x - 1 = 5x + 1$$

Forget $3 \times 2 = 6$; forget $2 \times (-1) = -2$. Correct: $3x + 6 + 2x - 2 = 5x + 4$

✓ **Correct solution**

$$5x + 4$$

$$\textcircled{1} 3(x+2) = 3x+6 \quad \textcircled{2} 2(x-1) = 2x-2 \quad \textcircled{3} (3x+6)+(2x-2) = 5x+4$$

🧠 **Tip: "Multiply outside the parentheses to avoid missing items when multiplying item by item; when combining similar items, the letter**

indices must be the same."

⚠ The most frequent error: the distributive law only multiplies the first term and misses the second term.
 $3(x+2) \rightarrow 3x+2$ (wrong!) $\rightarrow$ correct: $3x+6$

⚠ The second most frequent error: forgetting to change the sign when there is a minus sign before the bracket. $-(x-3) \rightarrow -x-3$ (wrong!) $\rightarrow$ correct: $-x+3$

Knowledge Point - Worked Examples

#	Question	Difficulty	Working Space
Example 1	Simplify: $2(x + 3) = ?$		
Example 2	Simplify: $4(2a - 1) = ?$		
6	Simplify: $5(y + 2) + 3y = ?$		
7	Simplify: $3(m - 4) + 2(m + 1) = ?$		
8	Simplify: $6 + 2(3x - 2) = ?$		
9	Simplify: $4(2a + 3) - 3(a - 1) = ?$		
10	Simplify: $2(x + y) + 3(x - y) - (x + 2y) = ?$		

Knowledge point 2: Two-step equation — $ax + b = c$ type SSPA must take the exam

Problem-solving tips: first process addition and subtraction, then multiplication and division (reverse operation)

- Step 1: Eliminate constant terms** ($-b$ or $+b$ on both sides of the equation at the same time) $\rightarrow ax = c - b$
- Step 2: Eliminate coefficients** ($\div a$ on both sides of the equation) $\rightarrow x = (c - b) \div a$
- Verification:** Substitute the answer into the original equation, the left side must be equal to the right side
- Key principles:** Both sides of the equation must do the same operation! "You do what, I do what"

①

**elimination
constant**

$-b$ on both sides leaves only ax on the left

②

**elimination
coefficient**

Find x by $\div a$ on both sides

③

verify

Substitute into the original equation to check that the left and right sides are equal.

④

answer

$x =$ Don't miss the value
 $x =$

Example (two-step equation)

Example 3: Solve $3x + 5 = 20$. Write out each step.

Example (two-step equation)

Example 4: Solve $4y - 7 = 13$.

✗ Common mistakes

$$3x + 5 = 20 \rightarrow x = 20 - 3 - 5 = 12$$

Move items randomly! There is no "simultaneous calculation of both sides of the equation". $3x$ is a whole and cannot be taken apart.

✓ Correct solution

$$x = 5$$

- ① $3x+5=20 \rightarrow$ Both sides -5 : $3x=15$ ② Both sides $\div 3$: $x=5$
③ Verification: $3(5)+5=20$ ✓

Tip: "First do additions and subtractions, then multiplications and divisions, and move both sides of the equal sign simultaneously; after completing the substitution test, it's just the reverse."

Knowledge Point 2 Synchronization practice

#	Question	Difficulty	Working Space
11	Solve the equation: $2x + 3 = 11$		
12	Solve the equation: $5y - 4 = 16$		
13	Solve the equation: $7m + 8 = 29$		
14	Solve the equation: $6p - 10 = 14$		
15	Solve the equation: $3x + 12 = 3$		

Knowledge point 3: Two-step equation — $a(x + b) = c$ type (bracket equation)

● SSPA Advanced

Two solutions (recommended method one):

Method one (cancel coefficients first): Both sides of the equation simultaneously $\div a \rightarrow x + b = c \div a \rightarrow$ both sides $-b \rightarrow x = (c \div a) - b$

Method two (remove the brackets first): Use the distributive law to expand $\rightarrow ax + ab = c \rightarrow$ becomes $ax + b = c$ type re-solution

- ① Both methods are correct, method one usually has fewer steps
② If $c \div a$ is not an integer, use method two (the fraction is left for final processing)

example

Example 5: Solution $2(x + 3) = 14$ (use method 1: cancel the coefficients first)

example

Example 6: Solve $3(x - 4) = 15$ (use method 2: remove the brackets first and compare which one is faster)

⚠ High-frequency trap: type $a(x+b)=c$, students often write $x+b=c-a$ directly (wrong!). Correct: $\div a$ first, not $-a$ first!

Knowledge Point 3 Synchronization practice

#	Question	Difficulty	Working Space
16	Solve the equation: $2(x + 1) = 8$		
17	Solve the equation: $3(y - 2) = 12$		
18	Solve the equation: $5(m + 3) = 25$		
19	Solve the equation: $4(x - 1) = 10$. Tip: $10 \div 4 = 2.5$, you can first use the distributive law to expand.		
20	Solve the equation: $2(3x + 1) = 20$ (process the coefficient 3 in the brackets first, then use method 1 or 2)		

III. Lesson Layered Synchronization Practice

Basic layer (total 5 questions, everyone must do)

#	Question	Difficulty	Working Space
21	Simplify: $3(a + 2) = ?$		
22	Simplify: $4x + 2x - 3x = ?$		
23	Solve the equation: $2x + 1 = 9$		
24	Solve the equation: $3(x + 1) = 15$		
25	Solve the equation: $6y - 5 = 19$		

Advanced layer (total 5 questions, choose do)

#	Question	Difficulty	Working Space
26	Simplify: $5(2m - 3) + 4(m + 2) = ?$		

27	Solve the equation: $4x + 9 = 2x + 15$ (hint: move the terms first, putting aside all those containing x)		
28	Solve the equation: $2(3x - 1) = 16$		
29	Solve the equation: $5(x + 2) - 3 = 17$		
30	Solve the equation: $3x + 7 = 4x - 2$ (hint: have x on both sides)		

 challenge layer (total 3 questions,  choose do, SSPAKiller Questions)

#	Question	Difficulty	Working Space
31	Solve the equation: $2(x + 3) = 3(x - 2) + 1$ Tips: First use the distributive law to expand both sides, and then transfer the terms to merge.		
32	When $x = 4$, $3(x + a) = 30$. Find the value of a.		
33	Solve the equation: $\frac{x}{2} + 3 = 7$ (equations containing fractions: eliminate the constant first, then the denominator)		

IV.applicationquestionspecial topic (equation + solution equation + answer sentence)

Knowledge Point 4: Two-Step Equation Application Questions SSPA Required

Four-step method for solving problems (must follow!): ① Let the unknowns ("Let x be...") ② Make an equation (Convert it into an equation according to the meaning of the question) ③ Solve the equation (Write the complete steps) ④ Write an answer sentence (Answer + unit, otherwise step points will be deducted!)

example

Example 7: Xiao Ming has a certain amount of yuan. After he spent 8 yuan, he divided the remaining money equally among his three younger brothers, and each brother received 4 yuan. How much yuan does Xiao Ming originally have?

#	Question	Difficulty	Working Space (let → column → solution → answer)
34	Xiao Ming has x yuan. He spent 15 yuan, and then spent three times the remaining money on books, for a total of 45 yuan. Find x. Tip: $3(x - 15) = 45$		

35	The length of a rectangle is 2 times its breadth plus 3 cm. If the perimeter is 42 cm, find the width. Tips: Let width = x, length = 2x+3, perimeter = 2(length+width) = 42		
36	Four times a number plus 7 is equal to six times that number minus 5. Find this number. Tips: Let the number be x, and write the equation 4x+7=6x-5		
37	The older sister is 5 years older than the younger sister. After 5 years, the older sister will be twice as old as the younger sister. Please tell me your sister's current age. Tips: Suppose the younger sister is x years old now, older sister = x+5. 5 years later: younger sister x+5, older sister x+10. Sequence equation $x+10 = 2(x+5)$		

V. Ultimate challenge area

#	Question	Difficulty	Working Space
 1	Solve the equation: $3(2x + 1) - 2(x - 3) = 4x + 11$ Tips: Remove the brackets first → merge similar terms → move terms → solve. Notice there are x's on both sides.		
 2	Simplify and evaluate: When $a = 2$, $b = -1$, find the value of $3(2a + b) - 2(a - b) + 4b$. Tips: Simplify the algebraic expression first, and then substitute the numerical values. Be careful with the minus sign!		
 3	The lengths of the three sides of a triangle are $(x+2)$ cm, $(2x-1)$ cm and $(3x-3)$ cm respectively. If the perimeter is 22 cm, find the value of x.		

VI. Mix comprehensive practice (mixed algebraic expression + equation)

#	Question	Difficulty	Working Space
38	Simplify: $2(x + 3) - (x - 4) = ?$		
39	Solve the equation: $8x - 3 = 5x + 9$		
40	If $3(x + 2) = 2x + 11$, find x.		
41	Solve the equation: $4(2x - 1) = 3(x + 3) + 2$		

 **General tips: "For algebraic simplification, break down the brackets first, and you will not go wrong by multiplying item by item; do the two-step equation in reverse, adding and subtracting first, then multiplying and dividing; set the unknown number for application problems, solve the problem in columns, and then answer the sentence."**

VII. Lesson after homework

Basic must-do questions (total 5 questions, must write out complete steps)

#	Question	Difficulty	Working Space
H1	Simplify: $4(2x + 1) = ?$		
H2	Simplify: $3(a - 2) + 5a = ?$		
H3	Solve the equation: $3x + 4 = 19$		
H4	Solve the equation: $2(x + 5) = 18$		
H5	Solve the equation: $7y - 6 = 15$		

Advanced choose do question (total 3 questions,  choose do)

#	Question	Difficulty	Working Space
H6	Solve the equation: $5(x - 2) + 3 = 2x + 4$		
H7	Solve the equation: $3(2x + 1) = 4(x + 3) - 5$		
H8	Xiao Ming has some stickers. After giving 8 stickers to his sister, he put 4 times the remaining stickers into the collection book, for a total of 36 stickers. How many stickers does Xiao Ming originally have? (Suppose the equation is solved)		

VIII. The Lesson core common errors summary

☒ Self-examination in this hall (tick after completion)

☐ I know the pitfalls of solving each knowledge point

☐ I can complete  basic questions independently

☐ I can challenge  advanced questions

☐ I remember the formula

 Review of Learning Objectives - After completing this lesson you should be able to:

☐ Identify all trap types in our hall

☐ Solve  basic questions independently (100% correct)

☐ Challenge  Advanced questions (80%+ correct)

☐ Explain the lesson formula to classmates

☒ **本堂自我檢查 (完成後打剔)**

☐ 我識得分辨每個知識點嘅陷阱

☐ 我能夠獨立完成  基礎題

☐ 我能夠挑戰  進階題

☐ 我記得住口訣

#	common error	Correct Approach
1	The distributive law only multiplies the first term : $3(x+2) \rightarrow 3x+2$	The number outside the brackets must be multiplied by each item inside the brackets SEP every item : $3(x+2) = 3x+6$
2	There is a minus sign before the parentheses and I forgot to change the sign. : $-(x-3) \rightarrow -x-3$	After removing the parentheses of the minus sign, the sign of each item in the parentheses must be changed: $-(x-3) = -x+3$
3	The two-step equation first eliminates the coefficients (wrong!) : $3x+5=20 \rightarrow x+5=20 \div 3$	First cancel the constants (addition and subtraction), then cancel the coefficients (multiplication and division): $-5 \rightarrow 3x=15 \rightarrow x=5$ on both sides
4	a(x+b)=c type first subtract a : $2(x+3)=14 \rightarrow x+3=14-2$	The brackets are a w hole, first $\div a$: $2(x+3)=14 \rightarrow x+3=7 \rightarrow x=4$
5	Forgot to change the number when moving the item : $3x+7=4x \rightarrow 3x+4x=7$	When moving the terms to the other side of the equal sign, + becomes - and - becomes +: $3x-4x=-7 \rightarrow -x=-7 \rightarrow x=7$
6	The same operations are not performed on both sides of the equation	"You do w hat, I do w hat" - both sides of the equation must do exactly the same operation simultaneously
7	Missing unknowns/missing sentences in application questions	The four-step method must be complete: ① Assume x ② Make an equation ③ Solve the equation ④ Answer the sentence + unit

 家長角落 · Parent Corner

今日學咗咩? 小朋友學咗「**Advanced algebraic expressions + two-step equations**」。

最易錯嘅 3 個陷阱: 留意老師圈出嘅陷阱題目

你可以問小朋友:「你可唔可以解釋「**Advanced algebraic expressions + two-step equations**」嘅最重要口訣俾我聽?」

溫馨提示: 唔需要識教數學 — 只需要問小朋友「點解咁計?」同「有冇檢查陷阱?」就夠。

 教師參考: 熱身題答案 $\rightarrow$ 1)___ 2)___ 3)___ 4)___ 5)___ | 課堂練習重點關注題號:  挑戰層 17-21

